CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

MRI TECHNOLOGIST IN THE AI ERA

The calmest room in the hospital, around the strongest magnet — and zero metal mistakes allowed.

★ **TL;DR — Around $75K median after a 1–2 year imaging pipeline and the MRI registry credential. The catch: most techs enter through radiography first, and the safety discipline is absolute.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

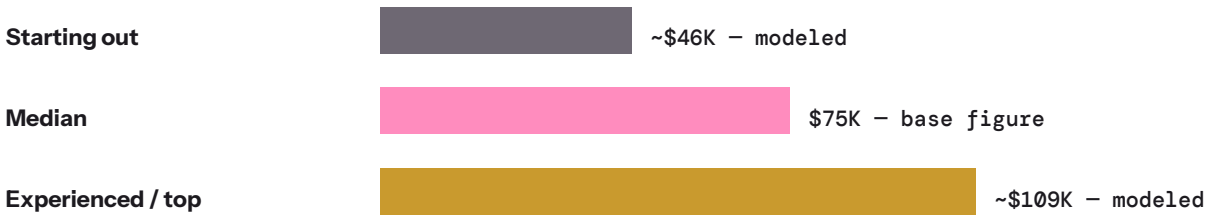
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1–2 years · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- MRI is a specialty layered on imaging: many employers want a radiography credential plus MRI training.
- The work is unhurried by hospital standards — long, precise exams with one patient at a time.
- AI accelerates reconstruction and protocol selection; it does not screen a patient with a pacemaker or run the exam.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for MRI Technologist is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A MRI TECHNOLOGIST ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Screen every patient and visitor for metal and implants — the safety gate is you
- ✓ Position patients and run MRI protocols, adjusting sequences to the order
- ✓ Monitor patients through long exams, coaching the claustrophobic
- ✓ Check images for quality and artifacts before the patient leaves the table

Think: an air-traffic controller for one very expensive, very magnetic runway.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI reconstruction cuts scan times and cleans noisy images; automated protocol suggestions keep improving. Scheduling and screening questionnaires are software now.	Safety judgment around implants and devices, patient management inside the bore, and adapting sequences when anatomy or hardware misbehaves. The magnet forgives nothing — the human is the safeguard.

⚠ **The direct-from-zero route exists but is narrow; most seats expect an existing imaging credential. And one screening lapse can be catastrophic — this job punishes the distracted.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Methodical pace, high-tech environment ✓ Deep one-patient focus instead of ward chaos ✓ Strong pay for a specialty credential	✗ Claustrophobic, anxious patients are a daily coaching job ✗ Magnet safety rules govern everything, forever ✗ Entry often means radiography school first — a longer runway

Good fit? Detail-obsessed, unhurried under pressure, and systematic about safety checks. Bad fit? You rush checklists or get restless in long, quiet exams.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — RADIOGRAPHY FIRST, THEN MRI	DOOR B — DIRECT MRI PROGRAMS
The common route: earn the radiography credential through an accredited 1–2 year program, then complete MRI training and the MRI registry. Most hospital MRI departments are staffed this way.	A smaller number of accredited programs teach MRI as a primary pathway without radiography first. Fewer seats and fewer employers accept it — check hiring requirements in your market before choosing.

Smart move: While in radiography clinicals, volunteer for every MRI rotation and screening shift — MRI managers hire the techs they've already watched be careful.

Where you land after: MRI technologist → senior/lead MRI tech, safety officer roles, advanced applications and education positions.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
CHOOSE YOUR	CLEAR PREREQUISIT	COMPLETE BASE	ADD MRI	PASS THE	TAKE THE

STEP 1 — Choose your route honestly

FREE · TODAY

- Survey MRI job postings near you: do they require a radiography credential first?
- List accredited programs for your chosen route and their start dates.

STEP 2 — Clear prerequisites

SEMESTER

- Anatomy, physics and math grades drive admissions in imaging programs.
- Shadow an MRI suite for a day — the pace surprises people.

STEP 3 — Complete base imaging training

1–2 YEARS

- Program coursework plus clinical rotations across imaging.
- Treat MRI rotations as auditions.

STEP 4 — Add MRI training

MONTHS · AFTER BASE

- MRI physics, cross-sectional anatomy and magnet safety — the specialty layer.
- Log supervised MRI exams toward registry eligibility.

STEP 5 — Pass the MRI registry

EXAM FEE · WHEN ELIGIBLE

- Sit the ARRT MRI credential exam.
- Keep every other credential current — employers check.

STEP 6 — Take the MRI seat

JOB HUNT · 2–6 WEEKS

- Apply to hospital MRI departments and outpatient imaging centers.
- First year: become the safety-and-screening person everyone trusts.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

☐ Today: read local MRI job postings and decide radiography-first vs direct.

□ Days 1–30: list programs; start prerequisite enrollment.

□ Days 31–60: prerequisites underway; shadow a full MRI day.

□ Days 61–90: submit program applications; interview prep done.

□ Day 90: you're in an imaging pipeline with the MRI layer planned — not guessing.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ STILL PATIENT. SHARP PICTURE. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.